

## Chapter 7: India during the Maurya Period

### Textbook Exercise Solutions & Answers



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#### 1. Answer in one sentence:

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##### Q1.) Why did the satraps begin to fight among themselves?

Following Alexander's sudden death in Babylon, an intense struggle for power and regional supremacy broke out among the satraps he had appointed.

##### Q2.) Who did Ashoka send to Sri Lanka for the spread of Buddhism?

Emperor Ashoka sent his son Mahendra and daughter Sanghamitra to Sri Lanka to propagate the teachings of Buddhism.

##### Q3.) What were the occupations of the people during the Mauryan period?

Major occupations included agriculture, ivory carving, weaving and dyeing cloth, metal work, shipbuilding, and producing distinct black glazed pottery.

##### Q4.) Which animal engravings are found on the pillars erected by Emperor Ashoka?

Magnificent, lifelike engravings of animals such as the lion, elephant, horse, and bull are found on the Ashokan stone pillars.

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#### 2. Can you explain?

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##### Q1.) Satrap

Before retreating from his Indian campaign, Alexander appointed Greek military governors to govern and administer his conquered territories. These provincial governors were called satraps.

##### Q2.) Sudarshan

Sudarshan was a historic irrigation dam and reservoir constructed near Junagadh in Gujarat during the reign of Emperor Chandragupta Maurya to support agriculture.

##### Q3.) 'Devanampiyasa'

This is an honored royal title inscribed by Emperor Ashoka on his stone edicts, meaning 'Beloved of the Gods and one who looks upon all with affection'.

##### Q4.) Ashtapad

Ashtapad was the ancient Indian board game of chess, played on an 8x8 grid board, which was very popular during the Mauryan period.

### 3. Recall and describe:

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#### Q1.) The extent of Chandragupta Maurya's empire.

1. Chandragupta Maurya overthrew the Nanda dynasty and established the Mauryan Empire with its capital at Pataliputra.
2. He conquered Avanti and Saurashtra, significantly expanding his domain across central and western India.
3. After defeating Seleucus Nicator, he annexed the northwestern provinces including Kabul, Kandahar, and Herat into the Mauryan Empire.

#### Q2.) The extent of Ashoka's empire.

Ashoka's vast empire extended from Afghanistan in the northwest and Nepal in the north down to Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh in the south, and stretched from Bengal in the east to Saurashtra in the west.

### 4. Match the following:

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| Column (A)            | Column (B) (Answer)                |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------|
| (1) Emperor Alexander | (b) Emperor of Greece              |
| (2) Megasthenes       | (a) Ambassador of Seleucus Nicator |
| (3) Emperor Ashoka    | (d) Emperor of Magadha             |

### 5. What is your opinion?

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#### Q1.) Alexander had to turn back.

Alexander's soldiers had endured severe hardships during continuous campaigning across foreign lands. Having been away from their families for years, they mutinied and refused to advance beyond the river Beas, compelling Alexander to begin his homeward journey.

#### Q2.) Coins of Greek kings were characteristic.

Greek coins were unique and distinct: one side featured a realistic portrait of the reigning king alongside his engraved name, while the reverse side depicted a Greek deity. These coins strongly influenced future Indian numismatic traditions.

**Q3.) Emperor Ashoka decided never to wage war again.**

Ashoka was deeply shaken by the devastating loss of life, bloodshed, and misery caused by the Kalinga War. This profound remorse led to a complete change of heart; he embraced Buddhism and resolved to conquer through righteousness (Dhamma-vijaya) rather than through warfare.

**6. Describe in your own words:**

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**Q1.) Public welfare works of Emperor Ashoka.**

1. Emperor Ashoka prioritized civic amenities and healthcare, establishing hospitals with free medical facilities for both humans and animals.
2. He built extensive roadways lined with shade-giving trees to ease travel.
3. He dug wells at frequent intervals and constructed comfortable rest houses (dharmashalas) along major highways for travelers.

**Q2.) Means of entertainment and sport of the Mauryan period.**

1. Villages and cities celebrated seasonal festivals marked by folk music, dramatic performances, and classical dances.
2. Spectator sports like wrestling matches, chariot racing, and hunting were widely enjoyed.
3. Indoor recreation included board games and the game of chess known as Ashtapad.